

ChatGPT



how do I use Claude Code as a .net developer?

As a .NET developer, the biggest mindset shift with [Claude Code](#) is that it works more like a terminal-native junior/senior pair programmer than an autocomplete tool. It can inspect your solution, modify multiple files, run tests, execute CLI commands, and iterate until things pass. [Anthropic+1](#)

1. Install it in a .NET-friendly setup

Follow the official setup guide:

[Claude Code setup docs](#)

Recommended environment for .NET:

- Windows + WSL2 (best experience)
- Git Bash also works
- Node.js 18+
- .NET 8 SDK or newer

Install:

```
Bash
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Then inside your repo:

```
Bash
cd MySolution
claude
```

[Claude API Docs+1](#)

2. Treat it like an autonomous CLI engineer

The sweet spot for .NET is giving it high-level tasks instead of asking for snippets.

Good prompts:

```
Add JWT authentication to this ASP.NET Core API using minimal APIs.
```

```
Refactor this service layer to use MediatR and CQRS.
```

```
Find all synchronous EF Core calls and convert them to async.
```

Fix nullable warnings in the Infrastructure project.

Claude Code can:

- inspect your `.sln`
- traverse projects
- run `dotnet build`
- run `dotnet test`
- edit multiple files
- retry when compilation fails

That “edit → build → fix → retest” loop is the real productivity boost. [Anthropic+1](#)

3. Best workflow for ASP.NET Core

A very effective loop:

Step A — Ask for a plan first

Analyze this solution and explain the architecture.
Then propose how to add a Notifications module.
Do not write code yet.

This reduces hallucinations dramatically.

Step B — Implement incrementally

Instead of:

Build a complete ERP system.

Do:

Create:

- Notification entity
- EF Core migration
- repository
- API endpoints
- validation
- unit tests

Claude Code is strongest when scoped to a bounded feature.

Step C — Let it run tests

Example:

```
Run all tests and fix failing ones.
```

or:

```
Run dotnet build and resolve all warnings in Application project.
```

This is where it outperforms normal chat-based AI tools.

4. Excellent use cases for .NET teams

A. Large refactors

Examples:

- migrate controllers → minimal APIs
- switch Newtonsoft → System.Text.Json
- convert repositories → specifications
- upgrade .NET 6 → .NET 8

Claude Code is particularly strong at multi-file consistency. [Anthropic](#)

B. EF Core work

Very useful for:

- migrations
- entity relationships
- async conversion
- query optimization
- fixing N+1 issues

Prompt example:

```
Inspect all EF Core queries for N+1 problems and suggest fixes.
```

C. Test generation

Great for:

- xUnit
- FluentAssertions

- integration tests
- mocking with Moq/NSubstitute

Example:

Generate unit tests for all handlers in Application/Orders.

D. Legacy enterprise codebases

This is honestly one of its best use cases.

Ask:

Explain how authentication flows through this solution.

or:

Trace how invoices are generated from API request to database save.

It's surprisingly good at architectural discovery. [Anthropic+1](#)

5. Create a CLAUDE.md file (very important)

This is one of the highest leverage things you can do.

At repo root:

```
Markdown
# CLAUDE.md

## Stack
- ASP.NET Core 8
- EF Core
- MediatR
- SQL Server

## Rules
- Use async everywhere
- Do not use repositories for simple CRUD
- Use FluentValidation
- All APIs return ProblemDetails
- Prefer minimal APIs
- Use Result pattern instead of exceptions

## Testing
- xUnit
- FluentAssertions
- Moq

## Architecture
- Clean Architecture
- Application layer cannot reference Infrastructure
```

Claude Code heavily benefits from repository-specific instructions. Research on real-world usage shows teams commonly use these manifest-style files to guide behavior consistently. [arXiv+1](#)

6. Use it from inside VS Code or Rider

Most .NET developers end up using:

- terminal pane + Claude Code
- IDE for reviewing diffs

Good flow:

1. Open Rider/VS Code
2. Open terminal
3. Run `cClaude`
4. Assign task
5. Review changes in IDE
6. Commit manually

This works better than pure chat UIs because Claude operates directly on the repo.

7. High-value prompts for .NET developers

Architecture review

```
Review this solution for Clean Architecture violations.
```

Performance audit

```
Find allocations and performance issues in this API.
```

Security review

```
Audit authentication and authorization flows for vulnerabilities.
```

Migration help

```
Upgrade this solution from .NET 6 to .NET 8.  
Update obsolete APIs and packages.
```

API modernization

```
Convert MVC controllers to minimal APIs.
```

8. What it's surprisingly good at

Understanding enterprise codebases

Especially:

- dependency injection graphs
- layered architectures
- EF Core flows
- build pipelines

Autonomous repair loops

It can:

- run builds
- inspect failures
- patch code
- retry

That agentic workflow is the core differentiator. [Anthropic+1](#)

9. What it still struggles with

Be careful with:

- domain-specific business rules
- gigantic prompts
- hidden runtime assumptions
- fragile reflection-heavy systems
- complex distributed systems

Always review:

- migrations
 - security changes
 - concurrency logic
 - serialization behavior
-

10. Recommended "AI-native" .NET workflow

A practical modern stack:

- Rider or VS Code
- Claude Code for implementation/refactors
- GitHub Copilot for inline completion
- xUnit + integration tests
- Dockerized local services
- CI validation

A common pattern is:

- Copilot = autocomplete
- Claude Code = autonomous engineering agent

11. Start with these 3 real tasks

If you want to learn fast, try:

Task 1

Explain this solution architecture.

Task 2

Generate integration tests for all auth endpoints.

Task 3

Refactor this feature to use CQRS with MediatR.

Those exercises will teach you:

- prompting
- repo guidance
- iterative workflows
- review discipline

much faster than tutorials.

For deeper docs and examples:

- [Claude Code Overview](#)
- [Claude Code Docs](#)



create a complete case study so that I can use claude for development step by step

Complete Case Study: Building a Production-Style ASP.NET Core System with Claude Code

This walkthrough simulates a realistic .NET development project where you use [Claude Code](#) as your AI pair programmer from start to finish.

You'll learn:

- how to structure prompts
- how to guide Claude effectively
- how to avoid common mistakes
- how to use iterative development
- how to let Claude debug/build/test autonomously

Project Scenario

We'll build:

“TaskFlow” — Team Task Management API

A production-style backend with:

- ASP.NET Core 8
- Clean Architecture
- EF Core
- SQL Server
- JWT Authentication
- CQRS + MediatR
- FluentValidation
- xUnit Tests
- Docker
- Swagger

Features:

- User registration/login
- Projects
- Tasks
- Task assignment

- Comments
- Role authorization
- Notifications

PHASE 1 — Initial Project Setup

Step 1 — Create the Solution

You manually create the solution first.

```
Bash
dotnet new sln -n TaskFlow
```

Projects:

```
Bash
dotnet new webapi -n TaskFlow.API
dotnet new classlib -n TaskFlow.Application
dotnet new classlib -n TaskFlow.Domain
dotnet new classlib -n TaskFlow.Infrastructure
dotnet new xunit -n TaskFlow.Tests
```

Add references:

```
Bash
dotnet sln add .
```

Step 2 — Open Claude Code

Inside repo:

```
Bash
claude
```

Step 3 — First Prompt

This is critical.

DO NOT ask Claude to immediately generate everything.

Use:

```
Analyze this repository.

I want to build a production-grade task management system using:
- ASP.NET Core 8
- Clean Architecture
- CQRS
- MediatR
- EF Core
- SQL Server
```

- JWT auth

Please:

1. Propose folder structure
2. Explain architectural boundaries
3. Recommend NuGet packages
4. Suggest development phases

Do not implement code yet.

Why This Matters

This forces Claude to:

- inspect repo
- understand context
- create a mental model
- avoid chaotic generation

This is how senior engineers work with AI.

PHASE 2 — Repository Guidance

Step 4 — Create CLAUDE.md

Now create:

Markdown

CLAUDE.md

Stack

- ASP.NET Core 8
- EF Core
- SQL Server
- MediatR
- FluentValidation

Architecture

- Clean Architecture
- Domain layer has zero dependencies
- Application layer cannot reference Infrastructure

API Standards

- Minimal APIs preferred
- Use ProblemDetails
- RESTful naming

Coding Rules

- Use async everywhere
- No synchronous EF calls
- Use cancellation tokens
- Prefer records for DTOs

Validation

- Use FluentValidation
- Validate all commands

Testing

- xUnit

```
- FluentAssertions
- Moq

## Logging
- Use structured logging

## Security
- JWT authentication
- Role-based authorization
```

Why CLAUDE.md Is Powerful

Now Claude behaves consistently across sessions.

Without this:

- style drifts
- architecture breaks
- inconsistent patterns emerge

PHASE 3 — Architecture Generation

Step 5 — Generate Solution Structure

Prompt:

```
Create the Clean Architecture structure for this solution.
```

```
Include:
```

- ```
- folders
- base abstractions
- dependency injection setup
- MediatR registration
- EF Core DbContext
- Result pattern
- global exception handling
```

```
After implementation:
```

- ```
- run dotnet build
- fix all compile errors
```

What Claude Usually Does

It will:

- create folders
- add interfaces
- configure DI
- install packages
- wire MediatR
- build solution

- fix issues iteratively

This is where Claude becomes powerful.

PHASE 4 — Authentication System

Step 6 — Add Identity + JWT

Prompt:

```
Implement JWT authentication.
```

```
Requirements:
```

- ASP.NET Core Identity
- JWT access tokens
- refresh tokens
- registration endpoint
- login endpoint
- role support
- password hashing
- authorization policies

```
Use:
```

- Clean Architecture
- CQRS
- FluentValidation

```
Then:
```

- generate EF migrations
- run build
- fix all errors

Important Technique

Notice the structure:

GOOD

```
Implement X with these constraints.  
Then build and fix errors.
```

BAD

```
Build auth system pls
```

Precise constraints dramatically improve output quality.

PHASE 5 — Feature Development

Step 7 — Build Projects Module

Prompt:

Implement Projects feature.

Requirements:

- Create project
- Update project
- Delete project
- Get project by id
- Paginated project listing

Architecture:

- CQRS with MediatR
- validators
- repository abstractions
- EF Core configs
- DTOs

Security:

- only admins can delete

Testing:

- generate unit tests

Then:

- run tests
- fix failures

Why This Works Well

Claude performs best with:

- bounded context
- explicit scope
- iterative implementation

NOT giant one-shot generation.

PHASE 6 — Debugging Workflow

Now let's simulate a real bug.

Step 8 — Introduce a Runtime Failure

Suppose API crashes during task creation.

Ask Claude:

Investigate why task creation returns HTTP 500.

Steps:

1. reproduce issue
2. inspect logs
3. identify root cause
4. fix issue
5. add regression test

This Is Where Claude Shines

It can:

- run app
- inspect stack traces
- patch code
- rerun tests
- verify fix

This autonomous loop is the main value proposition.

PHASE 7 — Refactoring Existing Code

Step 9 — Convert to CQRS

Suppose legacy services exist.

Prompt:

```
Refactor Task feature to proper CQRS.  
  
Requirements:  
- commands  
- queries  
- handlers  
- validators  
- Result pattern  
- remove business logic from controllers
```

Important AI Pattern

Refactoring tasks are often MORE reliable than greenfield generation.

Claude is excellent at:

- pattern consistency
 - moving code
 - renaming
 - dependency cleanup
-

PHASE 8 — Performance Optimization

Step 10 — Performance Review

Prompt:

```
Analyze the solution for performance issues.
```

Focus on:

- EF Core query efficiency
- allocations
- async usage
- N+1 problems
- unnecessary LINQ materialization
- middleware overhead

Apply safe optimizations only.

This Is Extremely Useful

Claude is very good at:

- `.ToList()` misuse
- sync-over-async
- Include overfetching
- IQueryable mistakes

PHASE 9 — Testing Automation

Step 11 — Generate Integration Tests

Prompt:

Generate integration tests for:

- authentication
- projects
- tasks

Requirements:

- WebApplicationFactory
- isolated test database
- authenticated requests
- happy paths
- validation failures
- authorization failures

Then run tests.

PHASE 10 — Docker + Deployment

Step 12 — Containerization

Prompt:

Dockerize the application.

Include:

- multi-stage Dockerfile
- docker-compose
- SQL Server container

- environment configs
- health checks

PHASE 11 — CI/CD

Step 13 — GitHub Actions

Prompt:

Create GitHub Actions pipeline.

Requirements:

- restore
- build
- test
- publish artifacts
- Docker build validation

PHASE 12 — Production Hardening

Step 14 — Security Review

Prompt:

Perform security audit.

Focus on:

- JWT vulnerabilities
- authorization gaps
- SQL injection
- sensitive logging
- DTO exposure
- mass assignment risks

PHASE 13 — AI-Native Maintenance Workflow

Now imagine future tasks.

Example: Add Notifications

Prompt:

Add Notifications module.

Requirements:

- in-app notifications
- unread tracking
- SignalR support
- mark as read
- pagination

Architecture:

- follow existing patterns
- reuse Result pattern

- CQRS
- validators

Example: Upgrade .NET Version

Upgrade solution from .NET 8 to .NET 9.

Tasks:

- update packages
- resolve breaking changes
- update Docker configs
- ensure tests pass

The Correct Claude Workflow

The ideal workflow looks like this:

1. Analyze
2. Plan
3. Implement incrementally
4. Build
5. Fix
6. Test
7. Refactor
8. Review

NOT:

Generate entire enterprise app instantly

Real-World Prompt Engineering Patterns

Pattern 1 — “Analyze First”

Analyze this module before coding.

Reduces hallucinations massively.

Pattern 2 — “Constrained Implementation”

Implement using:

- MediatR
- Result pattern
- async only

Constraints improve consistency.

Pattern 3 — “Autonomous Repair”

Run build and fix all compile issues.

One of the highest-value workflows.

Pattern 4 — “Generate + Verify”

Generate tests and ensure they pass.

Pattern 5 — “Architectural Enforcement”

Check for Clean Architecture violations.

Common Mistakes Beginners Make

Mistake 1 — Giant Prompts

BAD:

Build a scalable ERP with microservices.

Mistake 2 — No Repository Context

Without CLAUDE.md:

- inconsistent architecture
- random libraries
- style drift

Mistake 3 — No Verification Step

Always ask:

Run build and fix issues.

Mistake 4 — Trusting Everything Blindly

Always review:

- migrations
- security
- concurrency
- transactions
- auth logic

Advanced Workflow for Senior .NET Developers

Eventually your workflow becomes:

Claude handles:

- scaffolding
- repetitive code
- refactors
- tests
- boilerplate
- architecture discovery

You handle:

- business decisions
- system design
- security review
- domain correctness
- final approvals

That combination is extremely productive.

Recommended Daily Workflow

Morning

Analyze pending tasks from TODO.md
and propose implementation plan.

During Development

Implement feature incrementally.
Run tests after each step.

Before Commit

Review changes for:

- bugs
- security issues
- architecture violations
- performance concerns

Final Advice

The key insight:

Claude Code is NOT “better autocomplete.”

It is:

- an autonomous repo-aware engineering agent
- capable of iterative development
- strongest in scoped, test-driven workflows

The developers who get the best results:

- guide it carefully
- iterate in phases
- enforce architecture
- verify continuously

For reference:

- [Claude Code Docs](#)
- [Getting Started Guide](#)
- [Anthropic Claude Code Overview](#)



how to use copilot and claude combine for this?

Using [GitHub Copilot](#) together with [Claude Code](#) is one of the strongest modern .NET workflows because they solve different problems.

Think of it like this:

Tool	Best At
Copilot	Fast inline coding/autocomplete
Claude Code	Architecture, refactors, debugging, multi-file changes

The mistake many developers make is trying to use one tool for everything.

The Ideal Mental Model

Copilot = “typing accelerator”

Great for:

- methods
 - LINQ
 - DTOs
 - mappings
 - tests
 - boilerplate
 - repetitive patterns
-

Claude Code = “autonomous engineer”

Great for:

- feature implementation
 - repo-wide refactors
 - debugging
 - architecture analysis
 - build/test loops
 - migrations
 - large-scale changes
-

Recommended Setup for .NET

IDE

Use either:

- [JetBrains Rider](#)
 - [VS Code](#)
 - [Visual Studio](#)
-

Install Both

Copilot

Install:

- GitHub Copilot extension
- Copilot Chat extension

Official:
[GitHub Copilot](#)

Claude Code

Install:
[Claude Code Docs](#)

```
Bash
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

REAL Production Workflow

Here's the actual workflow senior developers use.

PHASE 1 — Architecture & Planning

Use Claude

Prompt:

```
Analyze this solution.

I want to add:
- Projects
- Tasks
- Notifications

Please propose:
- architecture
- CQRS structure
- entities
- handlers
- API endpoints

Do not implement yet.
```

Why Claude Here?

Because Copilot:

- does not understand repo architecture deeply
- cannot reason across large systems well

Claude excels at:

- system understanding
- architecture consistency
- planning

PHASE 2 — Scaffolding Feature

Use Claude

Prompt:

```
Implement Projects module using:  
- CORS  
- MediatR  
- FluentValidation  
- EF Core
```

```
Then:  
- run build  
- fix issues
```

Claude:

- creates files
- wires DI
- adds handlers
- builds solution
- repairs compile errors

This is high-leverage work.

PHASE 3 — Fine-Grained Coding

NOW switch to Copilot.

Example 1 — Writing LINQ

Inside Rider or VS Code:

You type:

```
C#  
public async Task<List<ProjectDto>> GetActiveProjects()  
{
```

Copilot completes:

- async EF query
- mapping
- cancellation token usage

This is where Copilot shines.

Example 2 — Mapping

You type:

```
C#
CreateMap<Project, ProjectDto>()
```

Copilot autocompletes mappings instantly.

Example 3 — Unit Tests

You type:

```
C#
[Fact]
public async Task CreateProject_Should_ReturnSuccess()
```

Copilot generates:

- arrange
- act
- assert

very quickly.

The Key Principle

Claude creates systems.

Copilot helps you type faster.

FULL CASE STUDY WORKFLOW

Let's walk through a realistic day.

SCENARIO:

Add "Task Comments" feature.

Step 1 — Architecture Design (Claude)

Prompt:

```
Design Task Comments feature.
```

```
Requirements:
```

- users can comment on tasks
- pagination
- audit fields
- soft delete
- authorization

```
Follow existing architecture.
```

Claude proposes:

- entity
- DTOs
- handlers
- endpoints
- indexes
- validators

Step 2 — Generate Feature Skeleton (Claude)

Prompt:

```
Implement Task Comments feature.
```

```
Requirements:
```

- CQRS
- validators
- tests
- EF configurations

```
Then:
```

- run build
- fix issues

Claude scaffolds everything.

Step 3 — Open IDE (Copilot Time)

Now you manually refine.

Example

You open:

```
C#  
AddCommentCommandHandler.cs
```

You start typing business logic.

Copilot:

- predicts EF queries
- suggests Result pattern usage
- autocompletes validation
- writes guard clauses

This massively speeds implementation.

Step 4 — Large Refactor (Claude)

Suppose comments should support mentions.

Prompt:

```
Refactor comments system to support:  
- @mentions  
- notifications  
- parsing  
- mention persistence  
  
Update tests accordingly.
```

Claude handles repo-wide updates.

Copilot cannot do this well.

Step 5 — Local Iteration (Copilot)

Now you tweak:

- regex
- edge cases
- serialization
- small methods

Copilot accelerates typing.

Step 6 — Verification (Claude)

Prompt:

```
Run all tests.  
Fix failures.  
Review for architecture violations.
```

Claude becomes your autonomous QA engineer.

PERFECT ROLE SPLIT

Here's the ideal split.

Use Claude For:

1. Large Features

```
Implement Notifications module.
```

2. Refactors

```
Convert controllers to minimal APIs.
```

3. Debugging

```
Investigate HTTP 500 during login.
```

4. Architecture Discovery

```
Explain how authentication flows through this solution.
```

5. Autonomous Repair

```
Run build and fix compile errors.
```

Use Copilot For:

1. Writing Methods

- LINQ
 - DTO mapping
 - helper methods
-

2. Test Boilerplate

- xUnit

- mocks
 - assertions
-

3. Repetitive CRUD

- property assignments
 - constructors
 - serialization
-

4. Inline Suggestions

- EF queries
 - API responses
 - FluentValidation rules
-

What NOT to Use Copilot For

Avoid relying on Copilot for:

- architecture
- security decisions
- large refactors
- understanding big systems
- debugging complex issues

It lacks strong repo-wide reasoning.

What NOT to Use Claude For

Avoid using Claude for:

- tiny edits
- line-by-line typing
- micro-iterations
- small syntax fixes

Copilot is faster there.

The BEST Hybrid Workflow

This is the modern high-performance setup.

Claude Terminal Session

Running:

```
Bash
cLaude
```

Used for:

- repo understanding
 - implementation
 - builds
 - debugging
 - testing
-

IDE + Copilot

Used for:

- coding flow
 - quick iteration
 - inline completions
 - tiny edits
-

Example Real Workflow

Claude

```
Implement project archiving feature.
```

Claude creates:

- entities
 - migrations
 - handlers
 - endpoints
-

Copilot

You manually refine:

- archive rules
 - edge cases
 - domain logic
 - mappings
-

Claude

Run tests and fix failures.

This Is the Productivity Multiplier

The combination works because:

Copilot reduces typing friction.

Claude reduces engineering friction.

Together:

- less boilerplate
 - fewer context switches
 - faster delivery
 - safer refactors
 - better architecture consistency
-

Recommended Daily Workflow

Morning Planning (Claude)

Analyze TODOs and propose implementation order.

During Coding (Copilot)

- autocomplete
 - test generation
 - repetitive code
-

Feature Implementation (Claude)

Implement feature incrementally.

Before Commit (Claude)

Review changes for:

- bugs
- security issues
- architecture violations

Practical Stack for .NET Developers

Best Combination

Tool	Purpose
Rider	IDE
Copilot	Inline completion
Claude Code	Autonomous engineering
Docker	Local infra
xUnit	Testing
EF Core	Data
GitHub Actions	CI/CD

Final Insight

The biggest unlock is:

Don't ask Copilot to think deeply.

Don't ask Claude to type every line.

That separation dramatically improves:

- speed
- code quality
- reliability
- architecture consistency

Official resources:

- [GitHub Copilot](#)
- [Claude Code Docs](#)
- [Anthropic Claude Code](#)



In my system there are following software's are installed.

Vs Code
Visual Studio 2026
SQ Server 22
Postman
Devart dbForge Studio
[Show more](#)[Show less](#)

Your setup is already strong for an AI-native .NET workflow. You have everything needed to use [Claude Code](#) + [GitHub Copilot](#) effectively.

Here's how to turn your current tools into a high-productivity development environment.

Your Current Stack

Software	Role
VS Code	Lightweight AI-driven coding
Visual Studio	Main enterprise .NET IDE
Microsoft SQL Server	Database
Postman	API testing
dbForge Studio for SQL Server	DB management/debugging

This is already a professional backend stack.

Recommended AI Workflow Architecture

Here's the ideal usage split.

Tool	Use For
Visual Studio	Main backend development
VS Code	Claude Code terminal workflows
Copilot	Inline autocomplete
Claude Code	Large implementation/refactoring
Postman	API validation
dbForge	Query inspection/performance
SQL Server	Local DB

Recommended Real-World Workflow

STEP 1 — Use Visual Studio as Main IDE

Use Visual Studio for:

- debugging
- breakpoints
- solution management
- profiling
- EF migrations
- test explorer

This remains your “control center.”

STEP 2 — Install Copilot in Visual Studio

Install:

- GitHub Copilot
- GitHub Copilot Chat

Official:

[GitHub Copilot Extensions](#)

STEP 3 — Install Claude Code

Open terminal:

```
Bash
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Docs:

[Claude Code Setup](#)

STEP 4 — Recommended Folder Structure

Example:

```
TaskFlow/
├─ src/
```

```

|   | API/
|   | Application/
|   | Domain/
|   | Infrastructure/
|
| tests/
|
| docker/
|
| CLAUDE.md
|
| TaskFlow.sln

```

STEP 5 — Create CLAUDE.md

This is VERY important.

At root:

Markdown

CLAUDE.md

Tech Stack

- ASP.NET Core 8
- EF Core
- SQL Server 2022

Architecture

- Clean Architecture
- CQRS + MediatR

Coding Rules

- async everywhere
- use cancellation tokens
- FluentValidation required
- minimal APIs preferred

Testing

- xUnit
- FluentAssertions

Database

- SQL Server
- use migrations
- avoid N+1 queries

This dramatically improves Claude's consistency.

HOW TO USE EACH TOOL TOGETHER

Now let's map your workflow.

Visual Studio = Main Coding Environment

Use it for:

- opening solution
- debugging
- reviewing changes

- test explorer
- Git integration

You'll spend most of your time here.

VS Code = Claude Command Center

Why?

Claude Code works beautifully in terminal-centric environments.

Recommended:

- open repo in VS Code
- open integrated terminal
- run Claude there

Example:

```
Bash
cd TaskFlow
cClaude
```

Copilot = Fast Typing Assistant

Inside Visual Studio:

You type:

```
C#
public async Task<Result<ProjectDto>>> Handle(
```

Copilot autocompletes:

- mappings
- handlers
- LINQ
- validation
- tests

Use Copilot for:

- small code
 - repetitive work
 - helper methods
-

Claude = Autonomous Engineer

Use Claude for:

- feature implementation
- debugging
- architecture
- refactors
- migrations
- build fixing

Example:

```
Implement Projects feature using:  
- CQRS  
- MediatR  
- EF Core  
- FluentValidation  
  
Then:  
- run build  
- fix compile errors
```

HOW POSTMAN FITS IN

After Claude generates APIs:

You verify manually in Postman.

Example flow:

Claude creates endpoint

```
Add CreateProject endpoint with validation and auth.
```

You test in Postman

Check:

- auth headers
- validation
- response payloads
- edge cases
- unauthorized access

This is VERY important.

AI-generated APIs should always be manually validated.

HOW dbForge FITS IN

This is where senior-level workflow happens.

Use dbForge for:

- query analysis
- inspecting indexes
- execution plans
- validating migrations
- checking generated SQL

Example AI + DB Workflow

Step 1 — Claude creates EF query

```
Optimize project listing query.
```

Step 2 — Run API

Step 3 — Inspect query in dbForge

Look for:

- table scans
- missing indexes
- N+1 problems
- unnecessary includes

This Combination Is Extremely Powerful

Claude:

- writes code

dbForge:

- validates DB behavior

FULL DAILY WORKFLOW

Here's the practical workflow you should follow.

MORNING — Planning (Claude)

Analyze TODOs and propose implementation plan.

FEATURE IMPLEMENTATION (Claude)

Implement Notifications module incrementally.

Claude:

- creates handlers
 - endpoints
 - migrations
 - tests
-

LOCAL CODING (Copilot)

Inside Visual Studio:

- refine methods
 - improve logic
 - tweak LINQ
 - add edge cases
-

API VALIDATION (Postman)

Test:

- JWT
 - status codes
 - payloads
 - validation
-

DATABASE VALIDATION (dbForge)

Inspect:

- generated SQL
 - indexes
 - execution plans
-

DEBUGGING (Visual Studio)

Use:

- breakpoints
 - watch window
 - diagnostics
-

FINAL QA (Claude)

```
Run tests and review:  
- architecture  
- security  
- performance
```

RECOMMENDED INSTALLATIONS

You should also add:

Node.js

Required for Claude Code.

Install:

[Node.js](#)

Recommended:

- Node 20+
-

Git

Required for modern AI workflows.

Install:

[Git](#)

Docker Desktop

Strongly recommended.

Install:

[Docker Desktop](#)

Useful for:

- SQL containers
- Redis
- integration testing
- deployment simulation

BEST PRACTICES FOR YOUR SETUP

1. Let Claude Handle Big Tasks

GOOD:

```
Implement authentication module.
```

BAD:

```
Write one property.
```

2. Let Copilot Handle Small Tasks

Use Copilot for:

- repetitive code
- DTO mapping
- tiny methods

3. Always Verify APIs in Postman

Never trust generated APIs blindly.

4. Inspect SQL in dbForge

AI tools often generate:

- inefficient includes
- unnecessary joins
- missing indexes

dbForge helps catch this.

5. Use Visual Studio Debugger Aggressively

AI-generated code can:

- compile correctly
- still behave incorrectly

Debugging remains essential.

EXAMPLE COMPLETE FLOW

Requirement

“Add task comments.”

Claude

```
Implement Task Comments feature with:  
- CORS  
- pagination  
- authorization  
- validators
```

Copilot

Refine:

- comment parsing
- helper methods
- mappings

Postman

Test:

- create comment
- auth
- validation

dbForge

Inspect:

- indexes
- query plan

Visual Studio

Debug:

- edge cases
- serialization
- transactions

Claude

Run tests and review architecture consistency.

Final Recommendation

Your optimal setup is:

Tool	Main Purpose
Visual Studio	Core .NET development
VS Code	Claude terminal workflows
Copilot	Fast coding
Claude	Autonomous engineering
Postman	API verification
dbForge	SQL analysis
SQL Server	Data storage

That is already a highly capable professional environment.